MANAGEMENT INFORMATION SYSTEMS
ICT2162
LECTURE 04

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Ethical and Social Issues in Information Systems

What we discuss today?

1. Introduction to ethical and social issues in information systems
2. Relationship between ethical, social and political issues
3. Ethics in digital and AI-driven society
4. Moral dimensions of information systems
5. Emerging concerns: AI ethics, data governance, and algorithmic bias

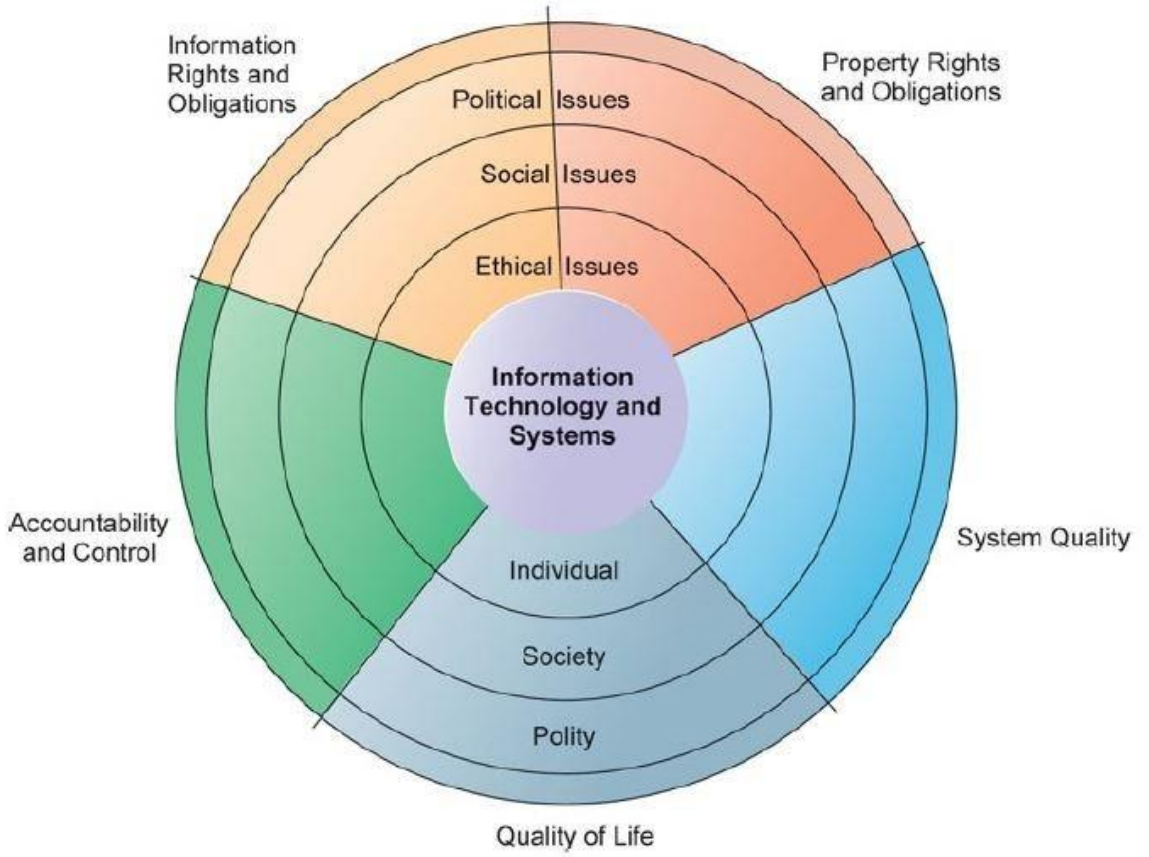
Introduction

- Changes in technology have positive consequences and negative consequences.
- Information technology can be used to achieve social progress, but it can also be used to commit crimes and threaten cherished social values.
- AI, Big Data, IoT, and Blockchain raise complex ethical and regulatory challenges.
- Information systems raise new ethical questions for both individuals and societies.

Ethics and Social issues

- Simply ethics is about professional behavior.
- Ethics refers to the principles of right and wrong that individuals, acting as free moral agents, use to make choices to guide their behaviors.
- Social issues are matters of concern to governments and the community.

Relationship Between Ethical, Social, and Political Issues



The introduction of new information technology has a ripple effect, raising new ethical, social, and political issues that must be dealt with on the individual, social, and political levels.

Ethical issues → personal and professional conduct

Social issues → community and societal well-being

Political issues → regulation, digital rights, and cybersecurity

Modern intersection : balancing innovation, human rights, and AI regulation.

Key Technology Trends that Raise Ethical Issues

1. AI and ML Expansion – bias and transparency concerns
2. Advanced Data Analytics – profiling and surveillance capitalism
3. Cloud and Edge Computing – data jurisdiction issues
4. IoT – massive data collection
5. Blockchain – privacy and inclusion ethics
6. Quantum Computing – encryption risks
7. Sustainability – green IT and e-waste

Ethics in an Information Society

Basic Concepts

- Responsibility: Accepting potential costs, duties, and obligations for your decisions.
- Accountability: Determining who should take responsibility for decisions and actions.
- Liability: Legally placing responsibility with a person or group.
- Due Process: ensuring the laws are applied fairly and correctly.
- Digital Trust – Transparency and data integrity

Five Moral Dimensions of Information Age

1. Information rights and obligations
2. Property rights and obligations
3. Accountability and control
4. System quality
5. Quality of life

Five Moral Dimensions of Information Age

1. **Information rights and obligations.**

   What **information rights** do individuals and organizations possess with respect to themselves? What can they protect?

2. **Property rights and obligations.**

   How will traditional intellectual property rights **be protected in a digital society in which tracing and accounting for ownership are difficult and ignoring such property rights is so easy?**

3. **Accountability and control.**

   Who can and will be held accountable and liable for **the harm done to individual and collective information and property rights?**

Five Moral Dimensions of Information Age

4. **System quality.**

   What standards of data and system quality should we demand to **protect individual rights and the safety of society?**

5. **Quality of life.**

   What values should be preserved in an information- and **knowledge-based society? Which institutions should we protect from violation? Which cultural values and practices are supported by the new information technology?**

01. Information Rights and Obligations

1. Privacy

2. Web site policies

3. Cookies

02. Property Rights and Obligations

1. Intellectual property issues
   Tangible and intangible products of the mind created by individuals or corporations.

2. Copyrights
   Copyright is a statutory grant that protects creators of intellectual property from having their work copied by others.

3. Patents
   A patent grants the owner an exclusive monopoly on the ideas behind an invention for 20 years.

03. Accountability and Control

Many of our law and court decisions establishing precedents in the area of accountability, liability, and control were strongly in place long before computers were invented. Along with privacy and property laws, new information technologies are challenging existing liability law and social practices for holding individuals and institutions accountable.

04. System Quality

- **Data Quality**

  We heavily depends and trust information systems.

  Therefore Data quality issues are more important.

  These issues affects both to customers and users.

- **System Errors**

  Software bugs and errors

05. Quality of Life

- What values should be preserved in an information- and knowledge-based society?
- Which institutions should we protect from violation?
- Which cultural values and practices are supported by the new information technology?

References

Management Information Systems 17th Edition by Laudon, K. C., & Laudon, J. P

Questions ???



Thank you…